

— SELL-SIDE M&A · OWNER'S GUIDE

The Madfarm *Process*

Structurally rigorous. Strategically flexible. Five phases and three decision gates, run as one continuous process — preparation is the same discipline on every engagement, and the market strategy is built for your business alone.

5

Phases, one
continuous arc

3

Decision gates,
each one yours

6

Deliverables,
yours to keep

01

How we work & the three
decision gates

02

The five phases, in detail

03

Deliverables & confidentiality

04

Your part, cadence & next
step

01 · HOW WE WORK

Structurally rigorous. Strategically flexible.

Two halves of one process — and they don't work in isolation.

STRUCTURALLY RIGOROUS

Preparation is fixed

- The same discipline, in the same order, on every engagement
- Every obstacle surfaced and mitigated before going to market
- A file a buyer can underwrite the day they receive it

STRATEGICALLY FLEXIBLE

Market strategy is built

- Buyer mix, sequencing and process type set to your goals
- Drawn from what preparation reveals — not a playbook
- Designed once, then executed with discipline

DECISION POINTS

Three gates control the process.

Nothing crosses a gate until the work behind it is done and you have signed off. Between gates we move without asking — **at each gate we stop, and the decision is yours.**

01

Launch approval

Before we go to market

- Financial workbook and deal-ready data room
- Approved CIM, teaser and buyer list
- Agreed go-to-market strategy

YOU DECIDE

02

LOI selection

When offers are in

- Competing offers weighed on price, structure, certainty and fit
- Counterparty diligence complete
- Exclusivity terms negotiated

YOU DECIDE, ON OUR RECOMMENDATION

03

Close

At the finish

- Confirmatory diligence complete
- Definitive agreements executed
- Working capital settled and funds flow confirmed

JOINT — WITH YOUR COUNSEL

02 · THE ARC

Five phases, one continuous arc.

The sequence holds on every deal. The pace does not — some businesses move quickly, others need room — so we scope the timeline to yours rather than a calendar.



IN DETAIL

What actually happens, phase by phase.

01	Evaluation COMPLIMENTARY · PRE-ENGAGEMENT	A discovery session and a preliminary read on value — what the business could command, what a process would look like, and what to address first. No cost, no obligation.
02	Foundation KICKOFF	Goals, data room build, and financial and operational discovery. Short and dense — it sets everything downstream in motion.
03	Preparation THE CORE	Financial preparation, quality of earnings, market analysis and go-to-market design. The heaviest lifting of the engagement, and what a clean process is built on.
04	Market IN MARKET	Tiered buyer outreach, NDAs and CIM, management meetings, then indications of interest and LOI selection. We name your buyer list from evidence — not on day one.
05	Close THE FINISH	Confirmatory diligence, definitive agreement, working-capital true-up and funds flow. Thorough preparation is why diligence confirms what's known instead of uncovering surprises.

We set the pace, and buyers react to it. In a sell-side process, **tempo is leverage** — and we don't hand it to the other side of the table.

03 · WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Six deliverables, all yours.

Produced during preparation, used through close, and yours to keep afterward.

01

Financial workbook

Normalized P&L, adjusted EBITDA, cash flow, customer analysis and net working capital — the underwriting file.

02

Deal-ready data room

Structured, populated, access-controlled and organized the way a buyer's diligence team works.

03

Confidential information memorandum

The full narrative and financial case for the business, released only under NDA.

04

Blind teaser

An anonymized one-page profile used for every first approach.

05

Buyer list

Named, tiered and researched — built from market evidence, not a database pull.

06

Go-to-market strategy

Buyer mix, sequencing, pacing, process type and the outreach plan.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Your business never appears on a marketplace.

Confidentiality is a design decision, not a disclaimer. Every approach is deliberate — made by us, to a named buyer — and nothing that identifies your business goes out until it has to.

Who gets read in, and when, stays your call.

HOW IT STAYS QUIET

Controlled from first contact

APPROACH	Named decision-maker
IDENTITY	Blinded until NDA
LISTINGS	Never posted publicly
DOCUMENTS	All through the data room

04 · YOUR PART

What we need from you.

The timeline holds when these are met — it is the one part of the process we don't control.

01 Responsive information

Document requests and diligence answered as they arrive, so preparation never stalls.

02 A few working sessions

Discovery and review sessions through preparation — the substance we build the file on.

03 Availability in market

Management meetings, and timely decisions on the offers that come in.

04 Counsel ready

M&A counsel engaged for the definitive agreement and close.

We tell you what's needed and when. You'll never learn about a deliverable on the day it's due.

HOW WE RUN IT

Cadence and communication.

Weekly standing call

A short status call: where we are, what's next, and what we need from you.

Written update

Delivered before each call — workstream status, blockers, and your upcoming items.

Direct escalation

Anything urgent goes straight to the principal. No account team to route through.

START WITH EVALUATION

Start with a read on value — not a commitment.

The complimentary pre-engagement — a discovery session and a preliminary valuation — comes before any paid work. No cost, no obligation.

SCHEDULE A CALL

Book a time on our calendar →

EMAIL

info@madfarm-advisors.com